

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 5
 ♥ Q J 10 8 7
 ♦ 9 6 2
 ♣ J 9 7 3

♠ K 9 7 6 4

♥ 6 4

♦ K 10 3

♣ K 8 2



♠ Q 2
 ♥ K 9 5 2
 ♦ Q 8 5 4
 ♣ 10 6 4

♠ A J 10 8 3

♥ A 3

♦ A J 7

♣ A Q 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ Q			

defenders will win, (you don't care which), and will be end-played.

The defender who won the last trick cannot lead a trump because he has none. If he leads a ♥ or a ♣ you will get a ruff-sluff, ruffing in one hand while discarding a ♦ loser from the other. If he leads a ♦ you will get the free finesse you were hoping for all along.

If you finesse East for the ♦ Q you make the contract, but if you finesse West for that card you go down.

With an elimination play you make it no matter who holds the Queen.

North's 3 ♠ bid is a limit raise showing 10-12 points and good trump support. South is to play 6 ♠. West leads the ♥ Q.

This ♦ holding is the first example shown in the introduction.

With one certain ♥ loser you cannot afford to lose a ♦ also. You could guess which way to finesse and be correct half of the time. But an elimination play will work ALL of the time.

Win the first trick and play ♠ A, ♠ K. Trumps split 2-1.

Next play three rounds of ♣s to eliminate that suit from both your and dummy's hand.

With all the eliminations completed you are ready for the throw-in. Lead a ♥ from either hand. One of the

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 2
 ♥ Q J 10 7
 ♦ K 9 6 4
 ♣ J 7 4

♠ K 9 7 6 4

♥ 6 4

♦ J 7 3

♣ Q 8 2



♠ 5

♥ K 9 8 5 2

♦ A 10 8

♣ 10 9 6 3

♠ A J 10 8 3

♥ A 3

♦ Q 5 2

♣ A K 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠

Pass 4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by South

Lead: ♥ Q

South is to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♥ Q.

This ♦ holding is the second example shown in the introduction.

This should remind you a lot of Deal 1. This time you have 1 ♥ loser and 3 ♦ losers. If you can force the opponents to lead ♦s you can make a trick with the ♦ Q or ♦ J, avoiding one of those losers.

Win the first trick and play ♠ A, ♠ K. Trumps split 2-1.

Next play three rounds of ♣s to eliminate that suit from you and dummy.

The eliminations are complete and it is time for the throw-in. Play the small ♥ from whichever hand you are in. This will be taken by one of the defenders.

No matter which defender wins the ♥ he is end-played. A ♥ or a ♣ will give you a ruff-sluff, but if he leads a ♦ you cannot be prevented from establishing either your ♦ Q or ♦ J as a winner.

If you try to make a ♦ trick on your own you will fail. The first defender will play "second-hand-low" and the other defender will take your ♦ Q (or ♦ J).

Only by forcing them to start the ♦s can you take a trick in the suit.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 2
 ♥ Q J 10 7
 ♦ Q 8 6 4
 ♣ J 7 4

♠ K 9 7 6 4

♥ 6 4

♦ K 10 3

♣ K 8 2



♠ 5

♥ K 9 8 5 2

♦ J 5 2

♣ 10 9 6 3

♠ A J 10 8 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 9 7

♣ A Q 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ Q			

a ♣ without handing you the contract by way of a ruff-and-sluff. So he must lead a ♦. Suppose it is West who leads the ♦. You play low in dummy and East must play either the ♦Q or ♦J to keep you from getting a cheap trick with your ♦9. So you take East's honor with your ♦A and then finesse West for the other honor. As long as the ♦Q and ♦J are in different hands the elimination play will succeed.

Against good defenders there is no way you can make all three ♦ tricks if you make the first play in the suit. This assumes that if one defender held both the ♦Q and ♦J he would "split" the honors if you tried to lead through them.

By forcing them to start the ♦s you make three tricks when the two outstanding honors are divided.

South is to play 6 ♠. West leads the ♥Q.

This ♦ holding is the third example shown in the introduction.

This is another follow-up to Deal 1. But this time you are missing both the ♦Q and ♦J. In this case an Elimination play doesn't give you a guarantee, it just improves your odds.

Win the first trick and play ♠A, ♠K. Trumps split 2-1.

Play three rounds of ♣s to eliminate the suit from you and dummy.

Now execute the throw-in by leading a ♥ from either hand.

The defender who gets thrown in cannot play a ♥ or

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 4

♥ 10 5

♦ J 10 9 3 2

♣ Q 7 4

♠ 9 7 3

♥ K J 8 2

♦ A 8 4

♣ K 10 3



♠ A Q 10 2

♥ 6 4

♦ Q 7 5

♣ 9 8 6 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ A Q 9 7 3

♦ K 6

♣ A J 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by South			
Lead: ♦ J			

will always be a luck factor.

Here you were lucky the defense didn't start by taking their three ♠s. If they had, you would not have been able to pull off the throw-in, and would have had to try your luck with guessing who had the ♣Q.

South is to play 4 ♥. West leads the ♦ J.

With three unavoidable ♠ losers you cannot afford to lose a ♣. So you either have to guess the location of the ♣Q or (DRUMROLL) pull off an elimination play! Win the ♦ K, then pull trumps, it takes two rounds.

Next you eliminate the ♦ s by playing ♦ A then ruffing the ♦ 8.

Execute the throw-in by leading a ♠.

The defense is in with a ♠ and they are welcome to take two more ♠s. But then they will have to have to play a ♠ or a ♦, giving you a ruff-sluff, or else lead a ♣ which finds the ♣Q for you.

Using elimination plays makes you a better player. But in Bridge, no matter how skillful you are, there

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 3
 ♥ A 9 6 5
 ♦ J 10 8 7
 ♣ Q 8 5

♠ K 9 6 4

♥ Q 7

♦ K Q 6

♣ K J 10 3



♠ 10

♥ K J 8 3 2

♦ A 5 4 2

♣ 9 7 4

♠ A Q 8 7 5 2

♥ 10 4

♦ 9 3

♣ A 6 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♦ J			

South is to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♦ J, covered by the ♦ Q and ♦ A. East returns a ♦ to the ♦ K.

You still have two losers in the ♥ suit, so the question is which way you plan to finesse the ♣s. And of course the answer is that you don't plan to finesse them at all!

Pull trumps with the ♠ A, then ♠ K. Next ruff dummy's last ♦.

Now exit with a ♥. The defenders win this and take another ♥ trick, leaving this position.

They must now break the ♣ suit for you or give you a ruff-sluff. Of course you would ruff in dummy and discard a ♣ from the 3-card holding in your hand.

If East is the one who has to play a ♣ you just let it ride around to dummy's ♣ K J 10 3.

If West is the one who has to play a ♣ you need to insert the ♣ 10 or ♣ J from dummy.

In either case you will no longer have a ♣ loser.